03 - PARTICIPANT RECRUITMENT PLAN

KIABI 360° Framework

User Research Workstream

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Status: Proposed recruitment plan. No participant, recruitment channel, interview, store access, or KIABI permission is confirmed.

1. Purpose of the Recruitment Plan

Recruitment connects research questions to first-hand evidence. Select people with relevant, recent experience rather than relying on assumptions or convenience.

Recruit customers and employees to explore online and store behaviour, cross-channel journeys, availability, frustrations, expectations, and operational constraints. The aim is useful qualitative insight, not statistical representation.

All numbers and channels in this document are proposed planning targets. They are not recruitment results and do not imply that any access has been granted.

2. Research Context

2.1 Documented KIABI context

Fittybird x Kiabi explores digital fit confidence across online and store journeys. Project data reports fitting satisfaction of 13% online and 75% in store, plus item-return rates of 26.5% and 3.7%. These figures do not establish that fit caused returns; return reasons and costs remain unknown. The project is web-first, with a possible later store pilot. Proposed screen-to-tablet flows are not confirmed deployments.

The project materials also describe product and size availability, fitting-cabin interactions, store staff support, online product information, loyalty-card use, and Click & Collect as relevant parts of the wider journey. The documents support a web-first direction and consider an in-store pilot later. The proposed Fittybird screen-to-staff-tablet flow is not evidence that the service is already deployed or approved.

2.2 Research objectives from Document 01

- Understand how people discover products, choose sizes, make purchase decisions, and experience returns online and in stores.
- Explore fit confidence, product and size availability, customer frustrations, expectations, and channel transitions.
- Understand employee observations and operational challenges that may shape the shopping experience or a future pilot.
- Keep interviews exploratory and neutral, and distinguish participant evidence from assumptions about the proposed solution.

2.3 Stakeholder groups from Document 02

Document 02 identifies three overlapping customer behaviour groups: online customers, physical-store customers, and omnichannel customers. It also identifies sales assistants, store managers, stock or inventory personnel, e-commerce or digital stakeholders, and customer service representatives. These groups guide recruitment planning, but access and availability for every group remain unconfirmed.

2.4 Recruitment decisions proposed here

This document proposes sample targets, eligibility criteria, possible channels, invitations, and tracking. All access and recruitment choices require confirmation; targets may change as gaps emerge.

3. Target Participant Groups

3.1 Customer participants

Online, physical-store, and omnichannel customers are Essential because their recent journeys directly inform customer questions. See Section 5 for experience criteria, topics, priorities, and possible channels.

3.2 Employee participants

Consider sales assistants, store managers, inventory, digital/e-commerce, and customer-service staff for operational context. Priorities vary by role; see Section 5. All access remains unconfirmed.

4. Participant Selection Criteria

4.1 Customer inclusion criteria

- Has purchased from KIABI or directly interacted with a KIABI shopping channel relevant to the research.
- Can describe a recent and specific shopping experience, rather than only general opinions.
- Has experience relevant to at least one journey: online, physical store, or a real transition between channels.
- Is willing to participate voluntarily and understands the proposed purpose and format.
- Can take part in the interview language agreed for the session.

4.2 Customer exclusion or deferral criteria

- No direct KIABI shopping or channel experience relevant to the research.
- Cannot recall a specific experience and can only speculate about what they might do.
- Feels pressured to take part or cannot provide informed agreement under the requirements confirmed for the study.
- Would require collecting sensitive or unnecessary information that is outside the research objectives.

4.3 Employee inclusion criteria

- Has direct experience with customer-facing or operational activities relevant to their role.
- Understands the process being discussed and can describe real situations, workarounds, or constraints.
- Participation is permitted by the relevant organisation and is voluntary.
- Can discuss the work without disclosing confidential customer or company information.

4.4 Employee exclusion or deferral criteria

- The person has no direct experience with the relevant process or customer interaction.
- Participation or access has not been approved where approval is required.
- The conversation would require sharing confidential information that is not necessary for this research.
- The person appears to be participating under pressure or without a clear understanding of the purpose.

Selection should be based on relevant experience, not whether a participant agrees with Fittybird, the project assumptions, or a preferred outcome. Customer channel categories can overlap; classify participants using the behaviour they actually describe.

5. Recruitment Profiles and Methods

Each profile summarises relevant experience, selection, topics, priority, and possible recruitment channels. Access is not confirmed.

Online customers

Recent KIABI online shoppers; direct, recent product/size or purchase experience. Topics: discovery, sizing, confidence, checkout, delivery and returns. Priority: Essential. Possible channels: networks, appropriate online communities, or KIABI contacts if approved.

Physical-store customers

Recent KIABI store visitors able to recall a product/size search; fitting-room use is optional. Topics: search, availability, fitting and staff help. Priority: Essential. Possible channels: in-store approach only with permission, networks, or approved KIABI contacts.

Omnichannel customers

People with a real recent journey across online and store channels. Topics: switching, Click & Collect if used, continuity and cross-channel returns. Priority: Essential. Possible channels: networks, approved KIABI contacts, suitable communities, or voluntary referrals.

Sales assistants or store associates

Staff with direct customer/fitting-area experience. Topics: requests, size support, tools and workflow. Priority: Important. Recruit through KIABI only if approved; do not approach at work without permission.

Store managers

Professionals with direct knowledge of store routines or pilot constraints. Topics: operations, staffing and readiness. Priority: Important. Possible channel: approved KIABI or professional referral.

Stock or inventory personnel

People directly involved in stock visibility or size availability. Topics: checks, accuracy, replenishment and handoffs. Priority: Important. Confirm the relevant role; contact only through an approved route.

E-commerce or digital team members

Professionals familiar with relevant online services, product information or data. Topics: sizing information, journey data and cross-channel limits. Priority: Important. Use KIABI or professional contacts only if authorized.

Customer service representatives

Staff handling relevant customer or return queries. Topics: support pathways and recurring question types, without identifiable cases. Priority: Interesting initially. Contact only if access and privacy conditions are approved.

6. Sample Size and Research Coverage

Proposed target: 12 customer interviews and 6 employee interviews (up to 18 people if feasible). These are planning numbers, not confirmed participants or completed interviews, and are not statistically representative.

6.1 Proposed customer distribution

- 4 participants whose primary recent experience is online shopping.
- 4 participants whose primary recent experience is physical-store shopping.
- 4 participants with a recent, specific journey across online and store channels.

The categories overlap. Count each person once, tag other channel behaviours, and revise the split if actual cross-channel participants are unavailable rather than misclassifying people.

6.2 Proposed employee distribution

- 2 sales assistants or store associates.
- 1 store manager.
- 1 stock or inventory professional.
- 1 e-commerce or digital professional.
- 1 customer service representative.

This proposed sample balances customer and operational views for exploratory insight, not representation. Adjust it if essential perspectives are missing or themes continue to emerge, subject to access and time.

7. Recruitment Process

1. Review Document 02 and prioritize relevant stakeholder groups.

2. Define profiles while allowing customer behaviours to overlap.
3. Set eligibility, recency, consent, and privacy criteria.
4. Identify channels and confirm permission and requirements.
5. Prepare a suitable English or French invitation.
6. Contact people respectfully; do not pursue declines or non-responses.
7. Explain the exploratory purpose and that this is not a sales pitch.
8. Explain participation choices and confirm willingness.
9. Check eligibility and assign an anonymous ID if appropriate.
10. Agree the interview format, language, date, and time.
11. Update the minimum-data participant tracker.
12. Confirm and remind participants; record any changes.

Keep the tracker access-limited. Store any scheduling contacts separately from interview notes and participant IDs; collect no unnecessary personal data.

8. Participant Invitation Messages

The 30 to 45 minute duration is a proposed estimate. Confirm actual access, note-taking, recording, and data-handling arrangements before inviting participants.

8.1 KIABI customer invitation - English

Hello, I am an EPITECH Master's student conducting exploratory research for the KIABI 360° Framework. I would like to hear about your real KIABI online or store shopping experience, especially product search and size choice. Would you consider a voluntary interview of about 30 to 45 minutes (proposed), remotely or in person? You may skip questions or stop. I will explain note and recording arrangements before you decide.

8.2 Invitation client KIABI - français

Bonjour, je suis étudiant en Master à EPITECH et je mène une recherche exploratoire pour le KIABI 360° Framework. J'aimerais comprendre votre expérience réelle d'achat chez KIABI, en ligne ou en magasin, notamment la recherche d'articles et le choix des tailles. Accepteriez-vous un entretien volontaire d'environ 30 à 45 minutes (durée proposée), à distance ou en présentiel ? Vous pouvez passer une question ou arrêter. J'expliquerai l'utilisation des notes et tout éventuel enregistrement avant votre décision.

8.3 Store employee or sales assistant invitation - English

Hello, I am an EPITECH Master's student researching the KIABI 360° Framework. I would like to understand store experiences with customer assistance, size availability, and fitting-area routines. Would you consider a voluntary interview of about 30 to 45 minutes (proposed)? It would focus on your experience, not performance. Notes or recording arrangements will be explained beforehand; participation requires relevant permission.

8.4 Invitation à un employé de magasin - français

Bonjour, je suis étudiant en Master à EPITECH et je mène une recherche sur le KIABI 360° Framework. Je souhaite comprendre les expériences en magasin liées à l'aide aux clients, aux tailles et à l'essayage. Accepteriez-vous un entretien volontaire d'environ 30 à 45 minutes (durée proposée) ? Il portera sur votre expérience, pas sur l'évaluation de votre travail. Les modalités de prise de notes ou d'enregistrement seront expliquées avant votre décision. Toute participation nécessite les autorisations requises.

8.5 Store manager or other relevant professional - English

Hello, I am an EPITECH Master's student researching the KIABI 360° Framework. I would like to understand operational processes affecting the shopping journey, availability, or a possible pilot. Would you consider a voluntary interview of about 30 to 45 minutes (proposed)? I will not request confidential information. Notes and any recording will be explained beforehand; contact and participation require KIABI permission.

8.6 Invitation à un responsable ou autre professionnel - français

Bonjour, je suis étudiant en Master à EPITECH et je mène une recherche sur le KIABI 360° Framework. Je souhaite comprendre les processus et contraintes liés au parcours d'achat, à la disponibilité ou à un éventuel pilote. Accepteriez-vous un entretien volontaire d'environ 30 à 45 minutes (durée proposée) ? Aucune information confidentielle ne sera demandée. Les notes et tout enregistrement éventuel seront expliqués avant votre décision; le contact nécessite l'autorisation de KIABI.

9. Interview Scheduling and Organisation

- **Format:** Offer in-person or remote options according to participant availability, accessibility, and any KIABI restrictions. Store interviews or approaches require permission; no site access is assumed.
- **Appointment:** Agree a date, time, duration, language, location or meeting link, and contact method. The proposed interview duration is 30 to 45 minutes.
- **Preparation:** Review the relevant participant profile, the research objective, the separate Document 04 interview guide, and any consent or information material approved for use. Avoid collecting personal data that is not needed.
- **Reminder:** Send one respectful reminder at an agreed time. Include the date, format, proposed duration, and a way to reschedule or withdraw.
- **Recording:** Record only after explicit permission and after confirming any institutional and KIABI requirements. If permission is not given, do not record.
- **Notes:** Use structured notes as a fallback. If another note-taker is present, explain their role and obtain any required agreement before the session.
- **After the session:** Update the tracker status, label notes with the participant ID, remove unnecessary identifiers, and store materials only in the approved location.

10. Participant Tracking Template

Use one blank record per potential participant and anonymous IDs (P01, P02, P03). These fields are a template, not actual participant data.

- **Participant ID:** P01
- **Participant category:** Online customer / physical-store customer / omnichannel customer / employee role
- **Recruitment source:** [source type only, for example network, approved store approach, or referral]
- **Eligibility confirmed:** Pending / Yes / No
- **Contact status:** Not contacted / Invited / Accepted / Declined / No response
- **Interview date:** Not scheduled / proposed date
- **Interview status:** Not scheduled / Confirmed / Completed / Cancelled
- **Notes:** Minimal, non-identifying logistics or eligibility notes only

Keep names and contact details out of the tracker. If needed for scheduling, store them separately in an approved, access-limited location.

11. Ethics and Data Protection

- Participation is voluntary. A potential participant may decline, skip a question, or stop without pressure.
- Explain the research purpose, expected duration, proposed use of notes, and the participant's choices before the interview.
- Obtain informed consent using the procedure confirmed with EPITECH and, where applicable, KIABI before collecting research data.
- Ask separately and explicitly for permission before recording. If permission is absent, use notes only.
- Respect participants' time and arrange a convenient format, language, and schedule.
- Use anonymous participant IDs in research notes and reports. Avoid unnecessary identifying details.
- Securely handle notes and recordings in the storage location and according to retention and access requirements that must be confirmed.
- Do not collect unnecessary personal or sensitive information. Do not request identifiable customer cases from employees.
- Respect a participant who does not wish to answer or continue, and stop if they ask to stop.

- Confirm any institutional ethics, consent, company access, recording, storage, and retention requirements before recruitment begins. This plan does not make unsupported legal claims.

12. Recruitment Risks and Mitigation

Difficulty accessing KIABI customers.

- **Potential impact:** The customer perspective may be missing or recruitment may be delayed.
- **Mitigation:** Check whether store or customer access is permitted; prepare alternative, appropriate channels such as personal networks or moderated online communities, subject to their rules.

Limited employee availability.

- **Potential impact:** Operational insights may be incomplete.
- **Mitigation:** Request access early, offer flexible scheduling, and avoid disrupting work. Do not contact employees at work without permission.

Overrepresentation of one customer behaviour.

- **Potential impact:** The research may miss important online, store, or cross-channel experiences.
- **Mitigation:** Track primary journey categories and overlapping behaviours; review coverage during recruitment and adjust where feasible.

Participants give only general opinions.

- **Potential impact:** Interview evidence may lack useful detail.
- **Mitigation:** Screen for recent experience and invite participants to describe a specific shopping or work event.

Interview cancellations or no-shows.

- **Potential impact:** The research schedule may be delayed.
- **Mitigation:** Confirm appointments, send a reminder, allow rescheduling, and maintain a small optional backup list only with consent.

Self-selection or positive-response bias.

- **Potential impact:** People with unusually strong views may dominate the sample.
- **Mitigation:** Use neutral invitations, recruit through more than one permitted channel where feasible, and seek varied outcomes rather than only satisfied users or returners.

Unclear consent, recording, or storage requirements.

- **Potential impact:** Recruitment or data handling may need to stop or be redesigned.
- **Mitigation:** Confirm EPITECH and KIABI requirements before contact or recording; use notes only if recording permission is not obtained.

Overlapping customer categories are counted twice.

- **Potential impact:** The proposed sample total may be misleading.
- **Mitigation:** Assign each participant one primary category for the target count and record other channel behaviours as additional tags.

13. Recruitment Success Criteria

- Essential customer perspectives are covered, or access limitations are clearly documented.
- Participants have direct, relevant experience and can describe specific situations.
- Online, physical-store, and actual omnichannel behaviours are represented without treating the categories as exclusive.
- Relevant employee perspectives are included where permission and availability allow.
- Interviews are scheduled and confirmations or changes are recorded accurately.

- The participant tracker is complete enough to monitor recruitment, uses anonymous IDs, and contains no unnecessary personal data.
- Proposed targets are clearly distinguished from actual recruitment and interview results.

14. Open Questions and Next Steps

Confirm the following before recruitment:

- Whether customer interviews or direct recruitment can take place in KIABI stores, and which permissions are required.
- Whether sales assistants, store managers, stock or inventory personnel, digital staff, and customer service representatives can participate.
- Whether KIABI can help identify or contact suitable participants, and what boundaries apply to that support.
- Which recruitment channels are permitted and appropriate, including personal networks and online communities.
- Whether interviews may be recorded, who may access the recordings, how notes and recordings must be stored, and how long they may be retained.
- Which EPITECH and KIABI information, consent, privacy, and ethics requirements apply to this student research.
- Whether the proposed initial sample and interview duration are feasible for the project schedule.

Once these points are clarified, finalise the recruitment messages, participant tracker, consent information, and schedule. Recruited participants will be interviewed using the separate document 04 - Interview Guides. This recruitment plan does not contain the interview script or report research findings.

References

- Document 01 - User Research Strategy, user-research/01-user-research-strategy.docx.
- Document 02 - Stakeholder Mapping, user-research/02-stakeholder-mapping.docx.
- 00-bootstrap/01-data-analysis.docx - KIABI channel metrics, item-return rates, and open data requests.
- 00-bootstrap/02-journey-maps.docx - online and in-store journey stages and touchpoints.
- 00-bootstrap/03-growth-levers-and-web-first.docx - web-first direction and proposed deployment sequence.
- 1a-product-manifesto/product-manifesto.docx - Fittybird x Kiabi product framing.
- 2a-personas/personas.docx - project user types and validation needs.
- B-methodology/methodology.docx - project user-centred process. The standalone EPITECH exploratory-interview presentation was not present in the repository materials reviewed for Documents 01 and 02; course-specific requirements should be confirmed with the supervisor.